



Index Number:

NATIONAL CERTIFICATE OF EDUCATION

2024

ENGLISH (N500)

TIME: 2 HOURS 15 MINUTES

Candidates answer on the Question Paper.

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

- 1. Write your index number in the space provided above.
- 2. Write in dark blue or black ink. Do not use correction fluid.
- 3. Any rough working should be done in this booklet.
- 4. Answer **ALL** questions.
- 5. For Question 10, answer either Option A or Option B.
- 6. This document consists of **10** questions printed on **21** pages, numbered **2** to **22**.
- 7. The number of marks for each question is given in brackets ().
- 8. The total mark for this paper is **100**.

For Examiners' use												
Question No.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	Total	Signature
Examiner												
Team Leader												
CE/ACE												

Question 1 (15 marks)

For items 1 to 9, circle the correct letter. Each item carries one mark.

1. Sahil is the boy in his class.
A stronger
B strongest
C as strong
D so strong

2. There is not milk left.
A many
B plenty
C lots
D much

3. We went the park for a picnic.
A at
B to
C for
D under

4. My brother has hurt his leg. They are taking to the hospital.
A him
B her
C them
D you

5. Devika to visit me tomorrow.
- A** was coming
B had come
C has come
D will come
6. Sarah and her friend cleaned their room
- A** herself
B himself
C ourselves
D themselves
7. The train will arrive ten minutes.
- A** in
B on
C at
D to
8. is the capital of France?
- A** Who
B Why
C What
D When
9. If I study hard, I pass the exam.
- A** was
B am
C will
D would

For items 10 to 15, follow the instructions given. Each item carries one mark.

10. **Underline the words which should begin with a capital letter.**

anne went out with her friends on thursday.

11. **Re-write the sentence below starting with 'Yesterday'.**

The bus is late.

.....

.....

12. **Re-write the sentence below in its interrogative form.**

James has forgotten his bag.

.....

.....

13. **Use the word in brackets to link the following sentences. Remember to make all necessary changes.**

She had not finished her homework. She went to sleep. (although)

.....

.....

14. **Re-write the sentence below in its negative form.**

Peter buys a book.

.....

.....

15. **Re-write the sentence below using indirect speech.**

"Did you see the accident?" the policeman asked him.

.....

.....

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Question 2 (5 marks)

For each item, circle the correct answer.

1. It is very today. Make sure you wear warm clothes. [1]

A cold	C dry
B sunny	D wet

2. The students that the school was dirty. [1]

A contributed	C congratulated
B complained	D consoled

3. I'm I will do well in my test. I have revised well. [1]

A doubtful	C surprised
B unsure	D confident

4. The 24th of May is a Friday. I have checked the [1]

A dictionary	C recipe
B calendar	D notebook

5. The in this orchestra are all very young. [1]

A officers	C musicians
B barbers	D drivers

Question 3 (10 marks)

Read the poster below and answer the questions that follow.



MAURITIUS ANIMAL SAVERS

Do you like animals? Do you want to save a life?
Then this poster is for you!

Mauritius Animal Savers is organising its annual Pet Adoption Day.
All members of the public are invited!

DATE: 21 December 2024
TIME: 10 00 – 16 00
LOCATION:
Bagatelle Shopping Mall

ENTRY FEE
Rs 50

All the money collected will go to
associations looking after stray animals



PET ADOPTION Day!

ACTIVITIES

-  Pet Care Workshops (nutrition, grooming, and behaviour training)
-  Kids' Corner (fun activities, bouncy castle, face painting, and educational sessions on pet care)
-  Food & Refreshments

Don't miss out on this incredible opportunity to change a life and bring joy into your home.
Open your heart and make a difference – adopt a pet today!

**For any further information, please contact the Director of Mauritius Animal Savers,
Mr Kevin Ramsamy.**



Address: 42, Royal Road, Port-Louis
Email: mas@brightville.mu
Phone: 5999-9999

1. Which event is being organised?
..... [1]
2. Which organisation is holding this event?
..... [1]
3. Who is invited to the event?
..... [1]
4. On which date will this event be held?
..... [1]
5. Where will this event take place?
..... [1]
6. How much is the entry fee?
..... [1]
7. What will be done with the money collected on that day?
..... [1]
8. Name one thing one may learn about in the Pet Care Workshops.
..... [1]
9. Who should be contacted for further information about this event?
..... [1]
10. What is the email address of the organisation holding this event?
..... [1]

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Question 4 (5 marks)

Write the correct form of the words in brackets. The first one has been done for you.

..... **Did** (**do**) you know that the Earth spins (**real**) fast? It travels at over 1,600 kilometres per hour! This (**amaze**) speed is why we experience day and night. As the Earth spins, different parts of the Earth face the sun, (**to make**) it daytime in those places. When other parts rotate away from the sun, they experience (**dark**). This (**rotate**) happens every 24 hours, giving us a cycle of days and nights.

(Adapted from: <https://kids.nationalgeographic.com/>)

Question 5 (5 marks)

Read the text below and correct the underlined mistakes. An example is given.

The Blue Penny stamp of Mauritius are one of the rarest and most valuable stamp in

..... is

the world. Printed in 1847, this stamps were first issued with the words "Post Office".

.....

This was in fact an eror. As a result, only a small number of stamps were produced,

.....

making them incredibly rare. Today, the Blue Penny stamp hold a special place in

.....

Mauritian history.

.....

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Question 6 (5 marks)

Complete the following text by writing one suitable word in each blank space. The first one has been done for you.

Exercising is like **having** a superpower! It gives you more energy, makes you feel good, and makes you sleep It also your bones and muscles. Try to exercise for at least one every day. This could be anything that gets you going, like dancing, or Moreover, exercise can you to improve your concentration. So, find something you enjoy and start exercising!

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You are the class captain. It is the end of the school year. Write a short note to your friends to organise a class party to celebrate the end of the school year.

- When will the class party be held?
- At what time will the party start and end?
- What will you and your friends do?
- What should each one of you bring?
- How will your teachers help?

[illegible]

Question 8 (20 marks)

Read the passage below and answer the questions which follow.

In the following passage, a young girl called Maya and her younger brother, Leo, unexpectedly find themselves alone at home during a storm. They are surprised when a dog enters their house.

- 1 Rain lashed against the windows, and Maya's heart pounded. The storm had arrived **unexpectedly**, and her parents were stuck at work, unable to drive home because of the weather. It was the first time that Maya was alone with her younger brother Leo. Leo, usually full of energy, was huddled under a thick blanket on the couch. Maya tried to appear calm, unsure how to deal with her brother's unusual mood. 5
- 2 Suddenly, a loud crack echoed through the house.
"What was that?" Leo asked, his voice trembling.
"Just a branch hitting the roof," Maya said, forcing a smile. She was doing her best to reassure Leo, but in truth, she was scared as well. To make matters worse, the lights flickered and died, plunging the room into the dark. Maya fumbled for the flashlight they 10 kept on the coffee table.
- 3 "Should we call Mum and Dad?" Leo asked. Maya hesitated. She knew her parents would be very worried and she did not want to make the situation worse for them.
"We'll be fine," she told Leo, trying to sound confident. "We just need to wait for the storm to pass." 15
- 4 The minutes crawled by. As the storm raged on, Maya tried to distract Leo by telling him stories. Her voice was shaky but determined. She sat close to Leo, holding him tightly to comfort him in the dark. Suddenly, they heard a loud thump. Leo jumped out of his seat, terrified.
- 5 Maya took a deep breath. She grabbed the flashlight and **crept** towards where the noise 20 had come from. Each step creaked as she walked slowly on the wooden floors. Maya peered into the dark, and suddenly, she saw it. A figure in the corridor, its outline moving in the light of her torch. She gripped the flashlight tighter, her heart hammering against her ribs. "Who's there?" she called out, her voice surprisingly calm.
- 6 Silence. Then, the shape started moving towards her. As it moved closer, its shape 25 became clearer. It was a large dog, its fur matted from the storm. Maya heaved a sigh of relief but quickly turned her attention to the dog. Was it hurt? How had it come in? She stroked its head cautiously, noticing that its beautiful brown eyes were filled with fear.
- 7 "You must be scared too," Maya murmured, her fear replaced by a feeling of protectiveness. She led the dog to the unlit living room, where Leo was waiting nervously. 30 He was amazed when he saw Maya walking in, a wet dog by her side. Maya smiled when she saw Leo's reaction. Together they made a makeshift bed for the dog and Leo offered it some of his food.
- 8 Gradually, the storm **subsided**, and the electricity came back on. As Maya and Leo watched the dog sleeping peacefully in their living room, a sense of accomplishment 35 washed over them. They had faced their fears...and found a new friend!

From Paragraph 1

1. Why were Leo and Maya alone at home?
..... [1]
2. What was different about Leo on that day?
..... [1]
3. Apart from the weather, what was troubling Maya?
..... [1]

From Paragraph 2

4. Maya forced a smile (line 8). Why did she have to force a smile?
..... [1]
5. What made "matters worse"? (line 9).
..... [1]

From Paragraph 3

6. Explain why Maya hesitated to call her parents.
..... [1]

From Paragraph 4

7. The minutes "crawled" by (line 16). According to you, why did Leo and Maya feel that time was moving very slowly?
..... [1]
8. Pick out the word from this paragraph which shows that the storm was very strong.
..... [1]
9. Give two ways in which Maya comforted Leo.
(i)
(ii) [2]

From Paragraph 5

10. Despite her fear, Maya went to see what had happened.
What does this show about her character?
..... [1]

From Paragraph 6

11. Maya “heaved a sigh of relief” (lines 26-27).
According to you, why was she relieved?

..... [1]

From Paragraph 7

12. According to you, why was Leo nervous? (line 30). Give two reasons.

(i)

(ii)

[2]

13. Leo offered the dog some of his food.
What does this show about his character?

..... [1]

From Paragraph 8

14. At the end of the storm, why did the children feel “a sense of accomplishment”?
(line 35). Give two reasons.

(i)

(ii)

[2]

From the entire text

15. Explain the meaning of the following words as they have been used in the passage.

- (i) unexpectedly (line 2):

A without warning

B very quickly

C as predicted

D quite violently

- (ii) crept (line 20):

A moved angrily

B moved slowly

C moved suddenly

D moved excitedly

- (iii) subsided (line 34):

A advanced faster

B went away

C stayed still

D lost intensity

[3]

Question 9 (15 marks)

Write an essay of about 200-250 words on one of the following:

- (i) Describe the scene in your neighbourhood on the day of a major festival or cultural event.
(Remember you must describe what you see and hear, the atmosphere, the people, and how you feel.)

Or

- (ii) "Students should be encouraged to have a part-time job during their school holidays." Do you agree?

Or

- (iii) Write a story based on the following line:
“I was very happy that I had made this decision.”

Option chosen:

[illegible]

Question 10 (10 marks) - Answer either Option A or Option B

Option A - Poetry (10 marks)

Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow.

Hope

Hope is the thing with feathers
That perches¹ in the soul,
And sings the tune without the words,
And never stops at all,

And sweetest in the gale² is heard;
And sore must be the storm
That could abash³ the little bird
That kept so many warm.

I've heard it in the chilliest land,
And on the strangest sea;
Yet, never, in extremity⁴,
It asked a crumb of me.

Glossary

1. *perches*: rests or sits on something
2. *gale*: a very strong wind
3. *abash*: hurt
4. *extremity*: very hard times

(Adapted from '*Hope*', by Emily Dickinson)

1. (a) Which **narrative voice** is the poet using in this poem?

- A** First-person
- B** Second-person
- C** Third-person
- D** Fourth-person

[1]

(b) Give one piece of evidence from the poem to support your answer.

..... [1]

2. Which one of the following is a pair of **rhyming words**?

A feathers, words

B heard, bird

C storm, warm

D land, extremity

[1]

3. (a) Which one of the following is a **metaphor**?

A Hope is the thing with feathers

B And sweetest in the gale is heard

C I've heard it in the chilliest land

D And never stops at all

[1]

(b) What is the effect of using a metaphor here?

..... [1]

4. What do you understand by the following lines from the poem?

(a) "And sore must be the storm
That could abash the little bird..."

.....
..... [1]

(b) "Yet, never, in extremity,
It asked a crumb of me."

.....
..... [1]

5. According to you, what is this poem about?

Support your answer with close reference to the poem.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [3]

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Option B - Prose (10 marks)

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow.

In the extract below, Kuno tries to convince his mother, Vashti, to visit him. In their world, human beings live underground in isolated rooms. Their lives are controlled by 'The Machine' and people communicate via a videoconferencing system.

Seated in an armchair in the middle of the room is Vashti, a small woman, with a face as white as a fungus¹. An electric bell rang. Curious to know who it was, she pressed a button and her chair rolled to the other side of the room.

"Who is it?" she called. Her voice was irritable², for she had been interrupted often. She knew several thousand people, thanks to the Machine. But when she listened into the receiver, her white face wrinkled into smiles, and she said: 5
"Very well. Let us talk, I will isolate myself. I can only give you fully five minutes, Kuno. Then I must deliver my talk on 'Music during the Australian Period'."

She touched the isolation knob, so that no one else could speak to her. It took Kuno, who lived on the other side of the earth, 15 seconds to appear on her screen, and she was already irritated by his delay. 10

"Kuno, how slow you are."

He smiled gravely.

"I have called you before, mother, but you were always busy or isolated. I have something particular to say." 15

"What is it, dearest boy? Be quick. Why could you not send a message?"

Kuno hesitated and then said, "I want you to come and see me."

Vashti watched his face in the blue screen.

"But I can see you!" she exclaimed. "What more do you want?"

"I want to see you not through the Machine," said Kuno. "I want to speak to you not through the wearisome³ Machine." 20

"Oh, hush⁴!" said his mother, vaguely shocked. "You mustn't say anything against the Machine."

"Why not?"

"One mustn't. We need the Machine." 25

"You talk as if a god had made the Machine," cried Kuno. Men made it, do not forget that. Great men, but men. The Machine is much, but it is not everything. I see something like you in this screen, but I do not see you. I hear something like you through this telephone, but I do not hear you. That is why I want you to come. Pay me a visit, so that we can meet face to face, and talk about the hopes that are in my mind." 30

Adapted from 'The Machine Stops', by E.M. Forster (1909)

Glossary:

1. *fungus*: plant-like organism such as mould or mushroom that does not produce chlorophyll
2. *irritable*: grumpy or bad-tempered
3. *wearisome*: stressful and enervating
4. *hush*: be quiet

1. (a) Which **narrative voice** is the narrator using in this extract?

- A** First-person
- B** Second-person
- C** Third-person
- D** Fourth-person

[1]

- (b) Give one piece of evidence from the extract to support your answer.

.....
 [1]

2. (a) Which one of the following is a **simile**?

- A** ... with a face as white as a fungus
- B** ... so that no one else could speak to her
- C** I want to see you not through the Machine
- D** ... so that we can meet face to face

[1]

- (b) What is the effect of using a **simile** here?

.....
 [1]

3. What do you understand by the following lines from the extract?

(a) “Her voice was irritable, for she had been interrupted often.” (line 4)

.....
 [1]

(b) “The Machine is much, but it is not everything.” (line 27)

.....
 [1]

(c) “I hear something like you through this telephone, but I do not hear you.”
 (lines 28-29)

.....
 [1]

4. Based on your reading of the extract, describe Kuno’s relationship with his mother.

Support your answer with close reference to the extract.

.....

 [3]

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